



So Frigg spoke to everything that existed in the cosmos, both living and non-living – stone, fire, water, trees, birds, snakes and other animals – and took from each a solemn vow that they would never harm Baldr.

Her task complete, the gods rejoiced that Baldr was safe from death – or so they thought. They amused themselves by throwing rocks and spears at him – and nothing caused so much as a scratch.

Loki the trickster god watched from the shadows, jealous of the attention Baldr was getting. Disguised as an old woman, he spoke to Frigg. “Is it true that you asked everything in the cosmos to do Baldr no harm?”



*“Everything apart from mistletoe,” said Frigg. “How could mistletoe harm my son?”*

“How indeed?” Loki said, hardly managing to hide his smile. He sped into the woods, and gathered some mistletoe.

Back in his true form, Loki sidled up to a blind god called Hodr, who was standing apart from the jollity.

